Project Charter Template

Agile Software Engineering Capstone

Document field	Team entry
Project title	‘Royal Budget’; A Personal Finance & Budgeting Application
Team name	Royal Development
Team members	Jake Hall, Cesar Giner, Jacob Melookaran, Joshua Webber
Project manager or team lead	Cesar Giner
Project sponsor	Commerce Bank
Customer or client	Commerce Bank Mentors
Instructor	Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain
Start and target end dates	September 04, 2026 - December 15, 2026
Version status and date	Updated 1.0, November 9, 2026

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Change and approval
0.1	September 25, 2026	Royal Dev	Initial draft, Team Approval
1.0	November 9, 2026	Royal Dev	Updated the mission objectives and scope, further refined the constraints, and defined the success criteria of the project.

1 Project Purpose and Authorization

1.1 Problem or opportunity

There are many people who have trouble with their finances, especially in a time where being strict with money might be more important than ever. The time for people using cash to budget is over and everything has transitioned to a digital world which can be harder than some to adjust to. Only being able to see charged transaction amounts can lead to a loss of confidence and continued avalanche effect with no path to take.

1.2 Project justification

Decision test	Team explanation	Evidence or source
Needed	Provides users a secure and accessible way to track personal budgets and spending by category with projected savings plans. Also included will be an easy-to-use AI assistant.	Commerce Bank sponsored Finance and Budget Application Project Charter Brief
Feasible	We believe that this team has the well-rounded technical expertise to complete this project within scope and requirements. We also have the help of the mentors of our sponsor who can fill the gaps in information we may have.	Team knowledge and skills in front-end, back-end, databases, generative AI, cybersecurity, UI/UX design and more. As well as the assistance of mentors, sponsors, and the course instructor.
Optimum	A budget tracking application allows the team to gain practical experience with a real-world company and employees while also furthering and developing our curriculum in computer science.	We would not have these same resources at our disposal if we were to implement this project on our own or as a group. The collaboration and resources we are privileged to have will help us learn at the highest capability.

1.3 Product vision

For individuals who struggle with tracking expenses and managing personal finances, the Commerce Bank Personal Finance & Budgeting Assistant is a secure web application that provides robust budgeting tools, expense monitoring, and financial planning to help users gain clear insight into their spending habits. A clean, streamlined application with easy to use functionality could help a lot of people to get on the right track.

1.4 Authority to proceed (Sponsor Fill Out)

Authorization item	Entry
Decision	[Approved to proceed / Approved with conditions / Revision required / Not approved]
Conditions	[List any conditions that the team must satisfy]
Authority granted	[State what the team may begin, such as requirements work, prototyping, and Sprint 1 planning]

2 Stakeholders and Team Authority

Identify everyone who can affect the project or is affected by its outcome. Record their needs and decision authority so the team knows whom to consult

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2.1 Stakeholder register

Stakeholder or group	Interest needs or expectations	Decision or contribution	Contact or review cadence
Project sponsor	Successful, working full-stack capstone application that satisfies given requirements by Commerce Bank	Approves vision and/or implementation of product	Commerce Bank
Customer or client	Budget and Finance Tracking Bank Application that is fully developed	Provides feedback and acceptance input through mentorship and a semester check-in	Rebecca Fantasma Anar Agayev Julio Gracida Clayton Sloniker
Target users	A budget tracking tool that is intuitive and usable regardless of technical background	Participate in informal usability feedback/testing sessions with team members	Will reach out to extended social network for quality and feedback, Beta Testing
Instructor	Course requirements are met and demonstrate agile software engineering practice	Clarifies course scope and assesses work	Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain shs6g7@umsystem.edu
Student team	A distinction between responsibilities that need to be carried out on a realistic and achievable timeline	Builds, tests, documents, and demonstrates the usability of a Finance and Budget Tracker Application	jmtqv@umkc.edu cesarginerkc@gmail.com jwebb9024@gmail.com jrhtyd@umkc.edu

2.2 Team roles and responsibilities

Team member	Primary role	Charter responsibility	Decision authority or backup
Jake Hall	UI/UX Design	Setting up charter initial draft	UI/UX design choices (Backup: Cesar)
Cesar Giner	Project Lead / Front-End Dev	Defining Project Purpose, Stakeholders Authority, and Project Goals/Features. Setting up a Git-hub repository for documents	Project Organization,Frontend architecture, data integration and user interface (Backup: Jacob, Jake)
Jacob	Back-End Lead	Defining Project Purpose, Stakeholders Authority, Milestones	Backend logic and database schema (Backup: Cesar)
Joshua	Security Architect / Project Documentation	Organize Project Direction	Project documentation, and security standards (Backup: Team consensus)

2.3 Decision and escalation rules

Routine development tasks and day-to-day implementation choices are delegated to individual team members, empowering them to drive design and technical problem-solving within their assigned areas. Major project milestones, scope adjustments, and architectural decisions are resolved collaboratively through team-wide consensus. In the event of a persistent deadlock where consensus cannot be reached, the team will consult the course instructor, Syed Jawad Hussain, for guidance and resolve.

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3 Goals Objectives and High Level Features

Goals describe the desired direction. Objectives make the expected outcomes specific and measurable. Features identify the main functions that deliver value to the client or users.

3.1 Project goals

Goal ID	Goal statement	Why it matters
G-01	Provide a fully developed finance and budget tracking application that aids users to budget, track expenses, and analyze their finances	Almost all of banking has transitioned to a digital medium pushing the need for an application users can use as a tool to achieve their financial goals
G-02	Deliver a secure, highly usable web application that protects user privacy and maintains regulatory compliance.	Ensures that handling sensitive personal financial data does not compromise user trust, while keeping usability high so the software remains accessible without technical barriers
G-03	Provide users with tools and services to understand their spending habits and make better financial decisions	Many users don't know how to interpret their numbers, the application's data visualization will and the LLM insights turn that data into action.
G-04	Deliver an application through agile practices, proper documentation and testing that meet course and Commerce Bank requirements.	Demonstrates industry-ready practice to the sponsor and instructor.

3.2 Measurable objectives

Objective ID	Specific measurable objective	Target date	How the team will verify it?(Demo, test result, metric, or approval)
OBJ-01	Complete Initial Draft of Project Charter	September 25, 2026	Team Approval
OBJ-02	Define Project Requirements	October 2, 2026	Team Approval
OBJ-03	Define Team Sprint Planning for Project Task/Implementation	October 15, 2026	Team Approval
OBJ-04	Deliver working midterm application with minimum requirements	October 29, 2026	Demo
OBJ-05	Unit tests covering budget application functionality and performance	December 1, 2026	Test Report, Code Coverage
OBJ-06	Conduct beta testing of application	December 1, 2026	Team Approval
OBJ-07	Provide the complete application, documentation, and final capstone presentation	December 15, 2026	Demo

3.3 High level features

Feature ID	Client valued feature	Primary user or stakeholder	Priority?(Must / Should / Could)
F-01	User Login Authentication and Registration	User	MUST
F-02	Home Dashboard	User	MUST
F-03	User Profile and Settings	User	MUST
F-04	Budget Planning and Transaction Logging	User	MUST
F-05	Data Visualization(stretch 1	User	MUST
F-06	Zap Security Scan(stretch 2)	User, Stakeholder	MUST
F-07	Cloud Hosting and Deployment Infrastructure	User, Stakeholder	SHOULD
F-08	AI Assistant/ChatBot	User	MUST
F-09	Application System Notifications	User	COULD
F-10	Session Persistence	User	SHOULD

4 Scope Priorities and Deliverables

4.1 Scope boundaries

In scope	Out of scope
The project scope includes the design and development of a secure web-based personal finance and budgeting assistant. Core deliverables include user registration and secure authentication, a centralized budgeting dashboard for tracking expenses by category, data visualization tools to monitor spending habits against financial goals, LLM integration, and a robust database integration to manage user data securely, all while incorporating a clean and optimal user interface experience.	The out-of-scope boundaries explicitly exclude real banking connections, real money involvement, and real card data(unless Commerce Bank explicitly updates the brief). Additionally, investment portfolio management, financial payment services, and mobile native applications are some of the boundaries/limitations to maintain a realistic delivery timeline.

4.2 Project priorities

Rank the priorities from 1 to 3. Use each rank once, then explain the tradeoff rule.

Priority area	Rank	Team agreement
Scope and product value	3	Since schedule is top priority, scope will be managed with non-essential features and optional capabilities being reduced to meet strict capstone deadlines.
Schedule and course deadlines	1	Fixed sprint and semester deadlines drive all delivery decisions, so scale of features and objectives will be reflected by realistic deadlines
Quality and technical standards	2	The quality and security must remain at an acceptable technical baseline regardless of deadlines and scope of project

4.3 Major deliverables and milestones

ID	Milestone or deliverable	Tangible evidence	Target date or sprint	Owner	Reviewer
M-01	Project charter approved	Approved charter	Sept 25,, 2026	RoyalDev Team	Instructor
M-02	Requirements baseline	Use cases, FRs, NFRs, and traceability	October 2, 2026	RoyalDev Team	Instructor
M-03	Architecture candidate reviewed	Architecture document and decision record	October 25, 2026	RoyalDev Team	Instructor
M-04	Midsemester increment	Working product increment and feedback notes	October 29, 2026	RoyalDev Team	Instructor
M-05	Feature complete	Testable release candidate	December 7, 2026	RoyalDev Team	Instructor
M-06	Final delivery	Application, tests, documents, and presentation	December 15, 2026	RoyalDev Team	Instructor

5 Resources Constraints and Assumptions

5.1 Preliminary resource and budget estimate

Estimate resources at a level appropriate for initiation. Student labor can be recorded in person-hours even when no money changes hands.

Resource	Estimated quantity or effort	Estimated cost	Source or availability	Owner
Student effort	4 member × 10 weekly hours = ~40 hours of work from the team per week	$0 course labor	Team in-person availability prioritized during the week, online communication encouraged	RoyalDev Team
Hosting or cloud services	Local Development	$0	Azure Deployment (if hosted)	RoyalDev Team
Development tools	VS Code, GitHub, Figma, Jira, MySQL, Python, Node.js(React)	$0	Open Source tools	RoyalDev Team
Equipment or test devices	Personal Computers	$0	Individual team members equipment	RoyalDev Team
AI	Limited AI API Token Use for Assistant Feature	$1-10	Anthropic's Claude API service	Cesar Giner

5.2 Constraints

Constraint ID	Limit placed on the product or project	Source	Effect on the team
C-01	Complete the project within the course schedule	Course calendar	The team must adjust scope before missing a required deadline
C-02	Use only fabricated financial and card data	Sponsor brief	The product cannot connect to real accounts or process real money

Constraint ID	Limit placed on the product or project	Source	Effect on the team
C-03	Project Specific limitations and requirements: ie must use a front-end framework and one CSS framework; no CMS, user passwords must be hashed, etc	Commerce Bank requirements	Defines the minimum scope; these features can't be cut
C-04	No Budget, open-source tools	Student Project	Limited resources

5.3 Assumptions and dependencies

ID	Type	Statement	How the team will validate or respond	Owner	Review date
A-01	Assumption	Commerce Bank's requirements remain unchanged	Confirm by email with the mentors if changes occur	RoyalDev Team	October 2, 206
A-02	Assumption	Each member can contribute to project	Check at weekly team meetings; redistribute tasks if someone falls behind	Cesar Giner	Weekly
A-03	Assumption	Testers from our network are available for usability feedback	Recruit testers before project complete	RoyalDev Team	November 9, 2026
D-01	Dependency	Open-source libraries (FastAPI, React, Tailwind, MySQL)	Tools are required to implement the application	RoyalDev Team	Daily
D-02	Dependency	An AI/LLM API Key	Spending limit set defined, key needed for AI functionality	Cesar Giner	Daily
D-03	Dependency	GitHub for version control, collaboration and documentation	Every member keeps an up-to-date local clone	RoyalDev Team	Daily

6 Success Criteria Risks and Agile Working Agreement

6.1 Project success criteria

Criterion ID	What success means	Measure or threshold	Evidence	Reviewer
SC-01	Users can manage their monthly budget end to end	A new user completes register → create budget → add income and expenses → view plan vs. actual, without help	Live demo + beta testing sessions with testers	Commerce Bank mentors, instructor
SC-02	Usable by anyone, regardless of technical background	Majority of testers complete the main tasks unaided, report usability high	feedback notes	Team, instructor
SC-03	The product is secure and reliable	0 critical ZAP findings, 100% of tests passing	ZAP report, test reports	Team, Instructor
SC-04	Delivered on time and meets all sponsor requirements	All required pages, unit testing and 2 stretch goals	Final presentation + requirements checklist	Instructor, Commerce Bank

6.2 Initial risks and obstacles

ID	Potential problem	Likelihood	Impact	First response	Owner
R-01	Uneven workload	Medium	High	Weekly check-ins, redistribute when someone falls behind	RoyalDev Team
R-02	Requirements misunderstood (e.g. stretch goals, required pages)	Low	Medium	Confirm open questions with Commerce Bank mentors by email	RoyalDev TEam
R-03	Security issues discovered late in development	Medium	High	Run security scans early and regularly to leave time for fixes	RoyalDev Team
R-04	Miscommunication within the team, misaligned direction	Medium	High	Agreed response times, frequent check-ins, clarify team direction and tasks	RoyalDev Team
R-05	Planned scope doesn't fit within the semester	Medium	High	Prioritize features (MUST/SHOULD/COULD); cut lower-priority features first; review progress weekly	RoyalDev Team

6.3 Agile working agreement

Working practice	Team agreement
Sprint length and ceremonies	Sprint planning at the start, a weekly check-in on progress and issues
Backlog ownership	The team maintains the backlog and its project priorities. Feedback from Commerce Bank mentors is prioritized in plan moving forward.
Definition of done	Code is on a feature branch and merged through a pull request; it runs locally without errors; relevant tests pass; the feature was tested end to end in the browser; the README or API docs are updated if behavior changed
Communication and response time	In-person meetings held at the university library, Discord is the primary channel of communication with responses to be made within 24 hours.
Scope change	Any team member may propose a change, provided it stays within the defined project scope and constraints. All changes require team agreement before they are adopted.
Conflict or missed commitment	If a conflict occurs, address with team members to reach a solution. If continued or unsolved, resolve with the course instructor.

7 Approval and Submission Check

Approval confirms that the reviewers understand the project purpose, boundaries, expected outcomes, and initial authority. It does not freeze the entire backlog. Record approved charter changes in the revision history.

7.1 Review decisions

Reviewer	Role	Decision	Conditions or comments	Date
Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain	Instructor	[Approve / Revise]	[Conditions or comments]	[Date]
Cesar Giner	Student Project Lead	Team Approval	The team has reviewed and approved the updated Project Charter	November 9, 2026

7.2 Signatures

Name and role	Signature	Date
Commerce Bank		
[Instructor]		
Cesar Giner, Project Lead	Cesar Giner	November 9, 2026

7.3 Version Notes/Remarks:

1. **Version:** v0.1 - Initial Draft

   Notes:

   - **Section 1.4:** To be completed by whom is formally authorized
   - **Sections 4.3 through 6.3:** Milestones, deliverables, resource estimates, constraints, success criteria, and agile workflows will be iteratively refined and updated as project analysis and requirements mature.

2. **Version:** v1.0 - Updated Project Charter

   Notes:

   - Revised project goals as user outcomes
   - Revised measurable objectives with targets
   - Completed milestones, resource estimates, constraints, assumptions and dependencies(sections 4/5)
   - Defined success criteria, initial risks and the agile working agreement, section 6
   - Waiting for Professor Review (Sections 1.4, 7)